

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 25, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski - Absent
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Brent Wilmot, Police Chief/Acting City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Chief Wilmot recommended removing Item D. FY2027 Fee Schedule to the next meeting on April 8th.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the March 11, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne - yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

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Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Parks and Recreation are hosting a Granite State Track and Field training for children ages 8-15, which will introduce them to track and field events such as running, jumping, and throwing. Registration is open through the first. First activity begins April 14th.

Kiwanis Club of Claremont and Newport Recreation will be hosting a free hunter safety course at the LaValley Community Center in Newport starting April 13th.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Chief Wilmot reported this weekend there will be a 5k race in the City to support MS research the course will be the same as the Pigskin 5K.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Candace Crawford, Ward II, was elected as the school board chair last week gave a financial overview, noted there was a contract signed last week for a forensic audit, right to know legal costs, and school reorganization.

Judith Koester, Ward II, introduced (ABC) A Better Claremont to the new councilors, a group that started in 2019 of concerned citizens in regard to Acuity Management wanting to come to Claremont, they plan to open a construction and demolition debris business and read a call to action from A Better Claremont.

Rebeccas Mackenzie, Ward II, thanked Council and read a press release about Acuity's proposal and the impacts on the City, then shared where to find resource lists and information on A Better Claremont website.

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NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2026-38 Drinking Water Infrastructure Project Application Approval

Director Gleeson is seeking permission to apply for the SRF loan through DES for drinking water funding opportunity. This would be 1.8-million-dollar funding with 40% loan forgiveness, which allows for the remainder of the Clay Hill project and preventative maintenance on water tanks in the City.

RESOLUTION 2026-38

Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Loan

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS the Claremont Water Utilities Division would like to submit a final application for the New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services (NHDES) Drinking Water State Revolving Fund for the amount of \$1,800,000.

WHEREAS the \$1,800,000 DWSRF Loan has been earmarked by the Department of Environmental Service for the City of Claremont to include an anticipated 40% loan forgiveness of approximately \$720,000.00

WHEREAS these funds will be used to complete the Clay Hill Water Main Project and the Water Storage Tank rehabilitation project which was selected to be on the 2025 DWSRF Project Priority List by the State of New Hampshire Drinking Water and Groundwater Bureau

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake all necessary actions to submit a final application for this loan and to approve the acceptance of these funds to begin the Clay Hill Phase 2 waterline project and Water Storage Tank Rehabilitation Project.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 25th day of March, 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

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A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-38.

Councilor Limoges read Resolution 2026-38 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne - yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2026-40 City Hall Repair Funding – Public Hearing

Mayor Girard noted this was brought up at the last meeting.

Treasurer Parks noted an addition of a generator repair needed, it was also mentioned that the number in the resolution was total costs but the City believes some of these expenses can be covered with grants and will not proceed with those repairs until the City confirms grant use.

RESOLUTION 2026-40

USE OF FUND BALANCE – CITY HALL REPAIRS

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, the City Manager has identified critical repairs needed for 58 Opera House Square (City Hall); and

THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to raise and appropriate a sum not to exceed One-Hundred Thirty-Six Thousand Six-Hundred Fifty dollars (\$136,650.00) from the General Fund Balance to perform the following work,

Main brownstone entrance stairs	\$15,200
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Opera House balcony rear aisle ceilings	\$55,500
Opera House balcony railing	\$25,000
Masonry chimneys at rear of building	\$15,650
Alley gutter and front roof corner	\$15,800
Generator repair/upgrade	\$5,000
Roof air-conditioning unit repair	\$4,500
Total	\$136,650

(with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 25th day of March 2026, in the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept Resolution 2026-38.

Councilor Hemingway read Resolution 2026-38 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne - yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2026-41 Safe Streets and Roads For All (SS4A) – Public Hearing

Treasurer Parks noted this is a resolution to adopt the Safer Streets 4 All based on the presentation from the last meeting essentially to reduce fatal accidents and injuries by 2030.

RESOLUTION 2026-41

ADOPTION – SAFER STREETS AND ROADS FOR ALL

WHEREAS, the life and health of all persons living and traveling withing the City of Claremont are our utmost priority, and no one should die or be seriously injured while traveling on our local streets and roadways¹; and

WHEREAS, Vision Zero is the concept that traffic deaths and serious injuries on our roadways are unacceptable; and

WHEREAS, Vision Zero is a holistic strategy aimed at eliminating all traffic fatalities and severe injuries suffered by all road users while increasing safe, healthy, equitable mobility for all; and

WHEREAS, streets and transportation systems have traditionally been designed primarily to move cars efficiently, and Vision Zero supports a paradigm shift by designing streets and transportation systems to move all people safely, including people of all ages and abilities, pedestrians, bicyclists, public transit users, scooter riders, and motorcyclists, as well as drivers and passengers of motor vehicles; and

WHEREAS, Vision Zero recognizes that people will sometimes make mistakes, so the road system and related policies should be designed to ensure that those inevitable mistakes do not result in severe injuries or fatalities; therefore, transportation planners and engineers, and policymakers, are expected to improve the roadway environment, policies, and other related systems to lessen the severity of crashes; and

WHEREAS, three (3) crashes have resulted in a loss of life, and 26 have resulted in serious injury of the 1,417 crashes in the City of Claremont between 2019 and 2023, and traffic crashes are among the leading cause of deaths in the United States²;

THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that the City of Claremont hereby adopts the principles of Vision Zero, the policy which is the basis of the Safe Systems Approach that underlies the SS4A Program, and commits to participate, in collaboration with Sullivan County and the NH Department of Transportation (NHDOT), in the USDOT Safe Streets for All (SS4A) Program with a goal to reduce and eliminate fatal and serious injuries by 2030 (majority vote required),

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A motion was made by Councilor Cogswell and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-41.

Councilor Cogswell read Resolution 2026-42 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne - yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor O’Hearne stated there was a Tolles Home Board meeting last week but there was nothing noteworthy to report.

Councilor Cogswell stated if any citizens want to join the EPA Steering Committee to please apply, and CCTV discussed new items/shows. Councilor Cogswell noted the Conservation Committee discussed tree planting in Broad Street Park.

Councilor Greenrose reported that the Energy Board had a full meeting and reviewed the charter and is doing their due diligence of all potential consulting groups with community power, the board will be making recommendations to Council in the future.

Councilor Irish noted the Procurement Committee sat in on a 2-hour OpenGov presentation which was very informative, transparent, and seems efficient thought it was a well-done presentation.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

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None.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:13 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Roll call:

O’Hearne - yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council